

Chapter 27-4

After Liang Shi finished speaking, she suddenly paused. Without waiting for the editor-in-chief to retort, she laughed and said, "Forget it, someone like you probably doesn't understand what personal dignity means."

Editor-in-chief: "...Fuck! What the hell are you talking about?!"

"Just the truth," Liang Shi said. "The truth is always harsh to hear."

The editor-in-chief was furious, "Get out! Get out of the magazine department!"

"No, get out of Dongheng!" the editor-in-chief shouted. "Trash like you doesn't deserve to stay at Dongheng."

"I won't leave," Liang Shi said, taking out her phone. "I recorded the entire meeting today. Every word and action of yours has been documented. I'll forward this recording to the president's office and let them decide. I believe Dongheng won't keep someone like you in the company. As for today's topic selection meeting with the general manager, I think we can present the planning department's marriage feature topic—Must everyone have a BARE when getting married? And positioning Dongheng's consumer base, with the subtitle: Everyone can own a BARE in their lifetime."

BARE was the luxury brand under Dongheng, internationally renowned, also known as Bali in Chinese.

Sometimes people jokingly called it Paris.

"Who are you?" The editor-in-chief sneered, "Really think you're somebody important? What gives you the right to decide topics? Did I nod and agree? Do you know who BARE's consumer base is? Rich people! A BARE silk scarf costs at least ninety thousand yuan. Do you think ordinary people can afford it? This topic was already used five years ago at the 'COCI' new product launch. What is Dongheng doing? Do we need to chew gum that others have already chewed? Are we specifically picking up trash? If you can't come up with innovative ideas, you can shut up! Get out!"

"Even if it's been used, can't it be used again? We can surpass it, we can do it from another angle. Why must we be limited by 'she used it, so I can't use it'? BARE's pricing is high, but does that mean ordinary people can never use high-priced items? Everyone is our potential consumer. Just because they don't have money today doesn't mean they'll never have money. Moreover, giving everyone a luxury dream, supporting everyone's right to own luxury goods—as a company, we should have a broad mind, not confine ourselves within walls."

The editor-in-chief was about to curse her for talking nonsense when applause suddenly rang out from the back.

Crisp applause rang out abruptly in the office area, not very enthusiastic, and only from one person.

The clapping rhythm was slow and steady, yet carried a hint of appreciation.

"Who's that? Are you sick..." The editor-in-chief was about to curse, but when she looked up and saw General Manager Liang, she quickly stopped, her face showing an awkward expression.

When Liang Shi turned around, she not only saw Liang Xinhe but also Xu Qingzhu.

Two of Liang Xinhe's assistants had come with them.

"Still want to curse at me?" Liang Xinhe approached with a smile that didn't reach his eyes, looking at the editor-in-chief. "I didn't know before that Editor-in-Chief Sun had such a big ego¹."

"No, General Manager, let me explain. It's because this newcomer is too ignorant of rules, and the magazine topics keep getting delayed. Without good topics, I was anxious..."

"Alright, no need to explain to me," Liang Xinhe said. "I only look at results. Are the magazine topics finalized?"

Editor-in-Chief Sun's face flushed with embarrassment, "Not yet."

"So what were you all just doing? Having an internal topic selection meeting?" Liang Xinhe asked.

"Yes." Editor-in-Chief Sun completely changed from her previous arrogance, becoming humble and respectful, even servile. "Deciding topics is inherently difficult, and with the deadline approaching, our discussion became somewhat... heated."

"Is that so?" Liang Xinhe still smiled, but no one would consider his smile friendly. "I've been here for a while and heard you constantly cursing at the newcomer."

"No." Editor-in-Chief Sun smiled awkwardly. "The newcomer's ideas were too foolish, so I was teaching her."

"Oh? Really?" Liang Xinhe reached out and patted Editor-in-Chief Sun's shoulder. "I couldn't tell, Editor-in-Chief Sun is so helpful and caring toward subordinates?"

Editor-in-Chief Sun nodded and bowed, "As it should be."

"But how did I hear you telling her to get out?" Liang Xinhe's eyes immediately turned sharp.

Editor-in-Chief Sun: "...Those were just words said in anger."

"What's the newcomer's name? Did she introduce herself? Did she chat with everyone?" Liang Xinhe turned to look at Liang Shi.

Liang Shi coughed softly, "Not yet."

All morning, who had time to care about her?

"Did she do any work?" Liang Xinhe asked.

Liang Shi shook her head, "No."

"Were tasks assigned?" Liang Xinhe asked again.

Liang Shi still shook her head, "...Still no."

Liang Xinhe was much taller than Editor-in-Chief Sun. The male Alpha stood nearly 1.85 meters tall, now looking down at the editor-in-chief from above. "Didn't you say the magazine department was short-staffed? I specifically transferred someone over for you, and this is how you use people? When I hired you, I heard you were good at managing people and had strong work capabilities, so I gave you an annual salary of 400,000 yuan. My requirements aren't very high—I didn't ask you to squeeze out Haiwei Jewelry's magazine and become first-class, just to simply create an electronic publication. Can't you even do that? Did I overestimate your work capabilities?"

"No...I..." Editor-in-Chief Sun immediately stumbled over her words, not knowing how to explain, feeling like she couldn't defend herself.

"The magazine department was too busy, I haven't had time to assign her work yet," Editor-in-Chief Sun said nervously.

She really didn't want to lose this job.

A 400,000 yuan annual salary was already top-tier for this industry. Her salary was higher than all her former colleagues.

Everyone knew she had entered Dongheng and was extremely envious.

Now her heart was anxious beyond measure, and she quickly added, "General Manager Liang, I really didn't do it on purpose. Today was too busy."

"You were too busy to assign her work, but had time to curse her bloody during the topic selection meeting. Is this how you treat the person I transferred to you? Are you dissatisfied with her or with me?" Liang Xinhe's tone was calm, but it scared Editor-in-Chief Sun so much her legs went weak.

Everyone understood—this airborne newcomer was backed by General Manager Liang.

General Manager Liang had come to support her.

No wonder the newcomer was so fearless after arriving, daring to directly confront Editor-in-Chief Sun head-on. So she was backed by a big tree to enjoy the shade².

Everyone cast sympathetic glances at Editor-in-Chief Sun.

But moments later, it turned to schadenfreude.

Served her right for being so arrogant usually. Now she'd kicked an iron plate.

"General Manager Liang, I didn't mean that. Today was just too busy..." Editor-in-Chief Sun was still desperately explaining, trying to excuse herself.

Liang Shi had already stepped forward, "General Manager Liang, I have a recording of today's meeting. You can listen to it, or I can email it to you."

Editor-in-Chief Sun glared at her resentfully, "Is there room for you to speak here?!"

Liang Shi: "...Should there be..."

She paused, looking at Liang Xinhe.

Liang Xinhe gave her an affirmative look, and she said with a hint of pride, "There should be, right? General Manager Liang, what do you think?"

Liang Xinhe nodded, "Of course."

Liang Shi was delighted. With someone backing her up, what couldn't she say?

"I think Editor-in-Chief Sun isn't suitable to work at Dongheng," Liang Shi said. "Her magazine philosophy doesn't align with Dongheng's, and the magazine department hasn't developed well under her leadership. If you really value Editor-in-Chief Sun as talent, you could try transferring her to other departments. But I thought about it—no department needs a professional curser."

Hearing this, Liang Xinhe's mouth curved upward.

Liang Shi said, "So I'll leave the decision to you."

Liang Xinhe looked at Liang Shi with appreciation and relief.

The feeling of a father seeing his daughter finally become successful.

Liang Xinhe didn't waste words and directly announced: "Editor-in-Chief Sun, you're dismissed. Go to Human Resources to collect this month's salary and severance pay."

"General Manager Liang, I really didn't do such things..." Editor-in-Chief Sun said. "Are you really going to fire me for a newcomer? I can lead Dongheng's magazine department to greater heights."

Liang Xinhe looked at her, "I can replace you with someone else and still make Dongheng's magazine department better. In this world, having ability doesn't mean you can do whatever you want. Moreover, in the month you've worked here, I haven't seen your abilities."

Editor-in-Chief Sun: "..."

She glared at Liang Shi resentfully, "You wait and see!"

Liang Shi shrugged helplessly and shook her head.

Just the impotent rage of a clown.

This farce quickly ended. Liang Xinhe told everyone in the magazine department to return to their workstations and instructed the planning team leader to present all topic proposals at the 5 PM meeting for discussion, encouraging them not to be afraid and to bravely express their opinions.

Liang Xinhe's approach to handling matters was completely different from Editor-in-Chief Sun's, making the planning team happy.

God knows how badly they'd been cursed by Editor-in-Chief Sun these past few days.

One girl hadn't slept for three days. Every day at work, her eyes were red and swollen because when she went home to sleep, she always felt someone was cursing at her, making her too scared to sleep and could only cry.

Editor-in-Chief Sun returned to her office to pack up.

While packing, she saw the resume on the desk—Liang Shi's, which she had handed in that morning. She hadn't even looked at it and just threw it on the desk.

Now furious, she picked up the resume intending to tear it up to vent her anger.

But she stopped when she saw the name.

The name column read—Liang Shi.

Liang Shi, Liang Xinhe, Liang Xinzhou.

All surnamed Liang.

A suspicion formed in her mind.

She suddenly became somewhat panicked, but still crumpled Liang Shi's resume into a ball and threw it in the trash like garbage.

Footnotes:

1. **官架子 (guān jià zi)** - "Official airs" or "bureaucratic attitude" - refers to someone who acts pompous or arrogant due to their position of authority.
2. **背靠大樹好乘涼 (bèi kào dà shù hǎo chéng liáng)** - "It's good to enjoy shade with your back against a big tree" - a Chinese idiom meaning it's advantageous to have powerful backing or support.